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# What Is Local AI? Explained

## Key Points

- **Local AI** runs directly on your **computer**, not in the **cloud**.
- Lets you use AI **without giving data** to big tech companies or joining **surveillance capitalism**.
- Tools like [LM Studio](#)<sup>[OBJ]</sup> make it easy to run models locally.

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## Tools and Setup

- **LM Studio:**
  - Free and **open-source**.
  - Works on Windows, macOS, and Linux.
  - Lets you **download AI models** to your device.
  - If you're on Windows, skip MLX (Apple-only).
  - Requires **enough RAM** (around 8–18 GB per model).
- **MLX Models** (Apple Silicon):
  - Faster performance on M-series chips.
  - Example: [qwq-32b-mlx](#) or smaller Qwen3 versions (1.7B–8B).
- **Phone Options:**
  - Android: **Private Local AI** (Google Play)
  - iOS: **LLM Farm** (App Store)

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## Model Examples and Sources

- **Qwen3** and **Gemma** models:
    - Built by **Alibaba Cloud**.
    - Trained on **public science and research** data, not copyrighted material.
    - Focused on **math, coding, and academic** content.
    - Smaller models can run locally with limited resources.
  - **Freepik's F-Lite Model:**
    - Image generator trained on **80M copyright-safe images**.
    - **First open-source visual AI** fully trained on **legal, safe-for-work content**.
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## Why Local AI Matters

- Keeps your data **private** and **offline**.
  - Works without internet — ideal for **low-connectivity** or **off-grid** setups.
  - Reduces reliance on **data centers** and **energy-hungry GPUs**.
  - Empowers individuals to **run**, **modify**, and **create tools** themselves.
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## Advanced Features (LM Studio)

- Supports **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** for plug-ins like:
    - [context7](#) for code or documentation lookup.
    - [filesystem](#) and [terminal](#) access.
  - You can store **custom system prompts** and create **specialized AI roles** (e.g., “SQL Analyst,” “Tutor,” etc.).
  - The AI can even **build new tools** for itself.
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## Resources Mentioned

- [LM Studio](#)
  - [Qwen3 \(Alibaba Cloud\)](#)
  - [Private Local AI \(Play Store\)](#)
  - [LLM Farm \(App Store\)](#)
  - [F-Lite Model \(Freepik\)](#)
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## Takeaway

Local AI means:

- You own the hardware.
  - You control the data.
  - You decide how AI runs and what it learns.
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